Mile Marker #1: My Starting Point

Every journey starts somewhere.

This first Mile Marker is about getting clear on where you are right now: why you're here, what you're hoping for, what you already bring to the trail, and where you stand with AI.

Your responses don't need to be perfect. They need to be honest and specific. You'll come back to this reflection later in the course when you build your capstone project.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Mile Marker #1 assignment in Blackboard. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Either way, upload the photo, scan, or PDF to the assignment. You can also type your answers in Blackboard instead.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

QUESTION 1

Why did you choose to attend college, and OCTC specifically?

What motivated you to take this step? Was it career goals, personal growth, a fresh start, family, stability, or something else? What made OCTC the right place?

- Name at least one specific reason you chose college.
- Name one reason you chose OCTC.

QUESTION 2

What does success look like for you this semester, in your own terms?

Consider grades, habits, balance, confidence, exploring careers, or something entirely personal to you.

- Define success in your own words.
- Connect it to something you actually want this semester.

QUESTION 3

What is one strength, habit, or quality you already have that will help you reach your goals?

Think about what you already bring to the table: work ethic, persistence, curiosity, communication skills, resilience, or something else. How will it support you this semester?

- Name one strength and explain how it will help you this semester.
- If you can, give an example of when it has helped you before.

QUESTION 4

What is one goal you want to accomplish before this semester is over, and what are two concrete steps you'll take to reach it?

Be specific. "Do better" isn't a goal. "Pass my math class" or "meet with my Success Coach twice" is a goal.

- State one specific, realistic goal.
- Name at least two concrete steps you'll take.
- Say what success will look like when you reach it.

QUESTION 5

Where does AI already show up in your life, and how do you feel about using it for school right now?

Name at least two places you already use or run into AI. They can be obvious, like a chatbot, or hidden, like autocorrect or your recommended videos. Then tell us where you stand today. Maybe you're excited, unsure, skeptical, or you'd rather not use it at all. All of those are fair answers.

- Name at least two specific examples of AI in your daily life.
- Describe honestly how you feel about using AI for school. There's no right position, only a clear one.
- If you can, name one way AI could support your learning without doing the learning for you.